

QUESTOR

HR User Guide

Logging in, running a first-round interview, and signing off the outcome

For	Recruiters, hiring managers, reviewers
What Questor does	Runs a structured, voice-first first-round interview, transcribes it, and produces an evidence-backed assessment
What it does not do	It never rejects anyone. Every outcome is a recommendation; a named human records the final decision, with a reason
Address	https://questor.187-127-166-193.sslip.io — the pilot deployment
Browser	Chrome or Edge

Contains guidance on handling candidate personal data. Share inside the hiring team only.

Technical companion documents: [docs/DEPLOYMENT.md](#) · [docs/VALIDATION.md](#) · [docs/compliance/](#)

1 Before you sign in

YOU NEED	DETAIL
The Questor address	https://questor.187-127-166-193.sslip.io — the pilot deployment. A local development install runs at <code>http://localhost:5173</code> instead
Your own account	One login per person — never a shared one (see section 2)
A browser	Chrome or Edge. Voice capture uses the browser's own speech engine, which Safari and Firefox do not fully implement. Candidates on other browsers can still type their answers
A microphone	Only for the interview room. Not needed for reviewing

2 Logging in

Go to the Questor address and enter your email and password on the sign-in page.

Your credentials

Everyone gets their own personal account. Ask Vishnu, who administers the pilot deployment, for one — and say which of the roles in section 3 matches what you actually do. Accounts are created on the server in a few seconds, so there is no reason to share one. Your password should reach you through something other than email, and should be treated like any other HR system credential.

There is no shared team login, and there is no self-service sign-up:

- **The “Register” link on the sign-in page is not your way in.** It creates a brand-new, separate organisation with its own empty database — it would not show you your colleagues' candidates. It is switched off on the pilot deployment.
- **demo@questor.local is not an account on the pilot deployment.** It is a development-machine login whose password is published in the public source code, and the script that creates it refuses to run against a production install. If you have seen those credentials in the README or a demo, they do not apply here — ask for a real account instead.

The pilot deployment holds real candidate data. As of the last handoff there were 19 real candidates in it. Everything you do in Questor is done to live records, and is attributed to you by name.

Rules the login enforces

RULE	WHAT IT MEANS FOR YOU
Sessions last 1 hour	You are signed out after an hour and need to sign in again. This is deliberate: Questor holds candidate personal data and often runs on a shared desk
10 failed attempts per 15 minutes	Repeated wrong passwords temporarily block sign-in. Wait 15 minutes rather than retrying
Passwords are at least 12 characters	Applies to any account your administrator creates
Never share a login	The audit log records who viewed and changed each assessment. Under a shared login, “who accessed this candidate's data?” has no answer — and candidates have a legal right to ask

Forgotten password

Questor currently has **no self-service password reset and no “change my password” screen**. If you forget your password, Vishnu resets it for you on the server in one command — there is no email you can trigger yourself. Passwords are stored only as one-way hashes, so nobody, including the administrator, can look up your existing one; it can only be replaced.

Signing out

Use **Sign out** at the bottom of the left sidebar. Always do this if you are stepping away from a shared machine.

3 What each role can do

Your administrator sets your role when creating your account. Roles are deliberately separated so that the person who writes a scorecard is not the person who signs it off.

	RECRUITER	MANAGER	REVIEWER	AUDITOR	ADMIN
Create a role / edit scorecard	✓	✓	—	—	✓
Approve a scorecard	—	✓	—	—	✓
Add candidates & resumes	✓	—	—	—	✓
View candidates	✓	✓	✓	—	✓
Create / invite / schedule interviews	✓	✓	—	—	✓
Run the interview room	✓	—	—	—	✓
Read assessments	✓	✓	✓	—	✓
Record the final decision	—	✓	✓	—	✓
Export to ATS	—	✓	—	—	✓
Read the audit log	—	—	—	✓	✓
Manage users, connectors, retention	—	—	—	—	✓

Two things follow from this table, and both are intentional:

- **A recruiter cannot approve the scorecard they wrote.** Ask a manager or admin to approve it.
- **A recruiter cannot sign off the outcome of an interview they ran.** A manager or reviewer records the decision.

You also only see the roles and candidates you are assigned to. An administrator controls those assignments.

4 The end-to-end workflow

The left sidebar is grouped by how often you use it: **Review** (your daily loop) on top, **Set up** below.

1 Create the role *Set up → New role*

1. Paste the **full job description**. The title is optional — Questor infers it if you leave it blank.
2. Submit. Questor produces a **Role Success Profile**: outcomes, responsibilities, a weighted competency model, red flags and prohibited topics.
3. Read it properly. This scorecard is what every candidate is measured against, and what an auditor will look at.
4. Correct anything wrong, then **Save**.
5. A manager or admin clicks **Approve**.

You cannot interview against an unapproved scorecard. Questor blocks it. This is the human approval gate, not a formality.

2 Add the candidate *Set up → Add candidate*

1. Pick the role.
2. Enter the candidate's full name and email.
3. Upload the resume (**PDF, DOCX or TXT**) — or paste the text.
4. Questor parses it and produces a **fit score** with the evidence behind it, plus **missing signals** and **suggested probes** for the interview to cover.

The fit score deliberately ignores age, caste, religion, nationality, marital status, appearance and accent. It is a starting point for the interview, not a screening decision.

3 Set up the interview *on the candidate's page*

Scroll to **Set up interview** and choose:

- **Duration** in minutes — the plan is built to fit the time you give it
- **Persona name** and **tone** — how the interviewer introduces itself
- **Provider** — leave as the hosted browser room unless IT says otherwise
- **Record of the interview** — what is retained

Click **Create interview**. Questor generates a versioned interview plan.

4 Invite the candidate *on the interview page*

1. Click **Send invitation**. This generates the candidate's private portal link.
2. **Check what the screen says about delivery**. If no mail provider is configured, Questor **logs** the invitation instead of sending it. If the badge does not say *email sent*, or a note says the email could not be sent, **copy the portal link and send it to the candidate yourself**.
3. The badge then tracks three real states: *not sent* → *email sent* → *opened by candidate*. “Sent” only means the mail provider accepted it. If it is still unopened after a day, ask them to check spam.
4. Optionally set a **Schedule** date and time.

The portal link is a key. Anyone holding it can start that interview. Send it to the candidate only, and never forward it internally. **It expires after 14 days** — use **Resend email** to issue a fresh one.

5 What the candidate experiences

They open the link and pass three screens before anything is recorded:

1. **Review** — what the interview is, that it is conducted by an AI, and that it will be transcribed.
2. **Consent** — they explicitly agree. They can instead request **an accommodation or a human alternative**, which routes them to your team rather than into the interview. Honour that request.
3. **Audio check** — enable mic, play a test sound.

Then they join the room. The interviewer speaks, they answer aloud and press **Done answering**. They can interrupt it, ask it to repeat, or **type their answers** instead if voice is not working for them.

You can preview the room yourself with **Open interview room (recruiter preview)** — useful for training, and for showing a nervous candidate what to expect.

6 Read the transcript

The interview page shows the full **diarized, timestamped transcript** — who said what, when. This is the source of truth for everything that follows.

7 Review the assessment *Review → Interviews → the assessment*

Questor produces a competency scorecard, a summary, a full report, and a recommendation of **Proceed / Consider / Do-Not-Progress** with a confidence level. Dimensions without enough evidence are marked **Not Enough Evidence** rather than guessed.

Do the blind review first. Click **Review the evidence blind**. You score each competency from the transcript and evidence *before* Questor's conclusions are shown to you, then record your own recommendation. Only then does it reveal how your call compares with the AI's.

This is not busywork. A reviewer who reads the AI's verdict and then agrees with it is anchoring, not reviewing — and a regulator reads that as an automated decision with a rubber stamp on it. Blind-first review is what keeps the human oversight genuine and evidenced.

If you must skip it, Questor requires a written reason, which is recorded.

8 Record the decision

In **Human review** on the assessment page, set the **Disposition**, give a **Reason** (mandatory), add comments and submit. Your name is attached to it. Every previous review stays visible — nothing is overwritten.

Then, if your ATS is connected, **Export to ATS**.

5 Troubleshooting

SYMPTOM	WHAT TO DO
"Invalid credentials"	Check the email is exactly right. After 10 failures you are rate-limited — wait 15 minutes
Signed out unexpectedly	Sessions last 1 hour. Sign in again
Can't find the Approve button	You are a recruiter. Ask a manager or admin to approve
"Role scorecard must be approved before interviewing"	Step 1.5 — someone needs to approve the scorecard
Candidate says they got no email	Check the delivery badge on the interview page. If it is not <i>email sent</i> , copy the portal link and send it yourself
Candidate's link doesn't work	It expires after 14 days. Click Resend email for a new one
Candidate's voice isn't picked up	Ask them to use Chrome or Edge, allow the microphone, and reload. They can type answers instead — the interview still counts
A candidate asks not to be interviewed by an AI	They can request a human alternative on the consent screen. Route them to a human interview
You can't see a candidate you expect to see	You are only shown what you are assigned to. Ask an administrator

6 Honest limits — read before rollout

These are real gaps in the current build, not caveats for the sake of it.

- **No user-management screen.** Accounts are created by the administrator with a command-line tool on the server (see the appendix). There is no "invite a colleague" button, so allow a little time when someone new joins.
- **No self-service password reset, and no "change my password" screen.** You cannot rotate your own password; the administrator has to reissue it. Treat the password you are given as the one you will keep.
- **Check that invitation emails are actually being delivered.** Unless a mail provider is configured, Questor logs invitations rather than sending them, and the interview page tells you which happened. Read that badge every time.
- **No bias audit has been done.** Questor recommends outcomes that affect people's employment. Its design avoids protected characteristics, but nobody has yet tested it for disparate impact across real demographic groups. In several jurisdictions that testing is a legal requirement, not a nice-to-have — it needs real data and counsel.
- **No load testing.** Behaviour at 20 or more simultaneous interviews is unknown, and the database is single-writer. **Stagger the first batch of invitations** rather than sending them all at once.

- **No monitoring or alerting.** A failure at 3am mid-interview notifies nobody. If a candidate reports a problem, say so — you are the alerting.
 - **Results so far are measured against simulated candidates**, not real ones. Read the first real transcripts next to their assessments before you trust the scoring.
 - **The database is not encrypted.** Candidate names, resumes and full transcripts sit in plain text. Server access controls are what is actually protecting them.
 - **Candidate notices need your counsel's review.** Drafts exist, but nobody on the engineering side can sign those off.
-

7 Your obligations as an HR user

- Tell candidates it is an AI interview, and that it is recorded and transcribed. The consent screen does this — do not work around it.
- Honour every accommodation or human-alternative request.
- Never ask, and never follow up on, protected characteristics. Questor blocks and rewrites prohibited questions, but the responsibility is yours.
- Decide from evidence. If a competency says **Not Enough Evidence**, that is information, not a negative.
- Write a real reason on every decision. It is what a candidate is entitled to see and what an auditor will read.
- One login per person, always.

Appendix — for your IT administrator

Creating the first administrator, and every HR account

There is no user-management screen, and the API cannot help you here: creating a user needs `admin:manage`, so you cannot make the first administrator through it, and `POST /api/auth/register` would mint a **separate empty organisation** that cannot see any existing candidate. The seed script is not the answer either — it wipes, and it refuses to run in production because its password is public.

So account setup runs on the server, next to the database:

```
cd /root/Questor/repo          # wherever the deployment lives

# See what exists today
npm run users -w server -- list

# Create the administrator (role defaults to admin)
npm run users -w server -- create --email you@yourcompany.com --name "Your Name"

# Then one account per HR user, with the narrowest role that fits their job
npm run users -w server -- create --email jane@yourcompany.com --name "Jane Doe" --role recruiter
npm run users -w server -- create --email sam@yourcompany.com --name "Sam Patel" --role manager

# Someone forgot their password
npm run users -w server -- reset-password --email jane@yourcompany.com

# Someone changed job
npm run users -w server -- set-role --email jane@yourcompany.com --role manager
```

Each command prints the credentials **once** — passwords are stored as bcrypt hashes and cannot be read back afterwards, only replaced. Hand them over through something other than email, and clear your terminal scrollbar.

Roles are `recruiter` · `manager` · `reviewer` · `auditor` · `admin` (section 3 says what each can do). A password is generated for you unless you pass `--password`; either way the 12-character minimum applies. The tool never deletes anything and never touches candidate data, and it refuses to demote the last administrator — that would lock the organisation out of user management permanently.

You need at least one manager or admin besides the recruiters. A recruiter cannot approve a scorecard or sign off an assessment, so an organisation of recruiters alone cannot complete a single hire.

Assigning who sees what

A non-admin sees only the roles and candidates assigned to them — a new recruiter signs in to an empty console until you assign them. Do that through the API with an admin token:

```
TOKEN=$(curl -s -X POST https://questor.187-127-166-193.sslip.io/api/auth/login \
-H 'content-type: application/json' \
-d '{"email":"you@yourcompany.com","password":"<your password>"}' \
| node -pe 'JSON.parse(require("fs").readFileSync(0)).token')

curl -s -H "authorization: Bearer $TOKEN" \
https://questor.187-127-166-193.sslip.io/api/admin/users

curl -s -X POST -H "authorization: Bearer $TOKEN" \
https://questor.187-127-166-193.sslip.io/api/admin/users/<userId>/roles/<roleId>
```

A role change does not affect an already-signed-in user until their session expires, within the hour.

Operating the pilot deployment

The pilot runs at `https://questor.187-127-166-193.sslip.io` — a temporary address for the pilot. It already holds real candidate data, so treat it as a live system.

- `GET /api/health` returns the running commit. Check it before sending a batch of invitations.
- Never run the interview simulator against it. `session.ts` refuses without `ALLOW_SIM_SEED` — leave it that way.
- The full hardening checklist is in `docs/DEPLOYMENT.md`; standing gaps are tracked in `docs/Questor-update-2026-08-06.md`.

Worth confirming for this deployment, since HR feels each one directly:

- ☐ A mail provider (SendGrid or SMTP) is configured, so invitations reach candidates
- ☐ `AUTH_SECRET` is a generated value, not the published default
- ☐ No `demo@questor.local` account exists
- ☐ Backups are running, and the backup location is restricted too
- ☐ Each HR user has their own account, with the narrowest role that fits their job